

Losing Your Job Without Losing Your Shirt

The average worker changes jobs at least half a dozen times. In this era of corporate takeovers, downsizing, mergers, layoffs, and most recently, stunning corporate corruption, nobody is immune from sudden job loss.

Prepare for the Possibility of Job Loss

You don't need to be paranoid, but being prepared for the possibility of job loss will make it easier to deal with if it does happen. To be prepared, you need to know your net worth, set up a budget, save, and keep your debt low.



According to the U.S. Department of Labor's Bureau of Labor Statistics, during 2011 there were over 6,000 mass layoff events in the United States resulting in over 1 million new unemployment claims. Mass layoffs involve at least fifty people at a time.

You should also have a feel for the stability of your job. How are your employer's competitors doing? Are they experiencing layoffs? Layoffs in your industry can be a good indication of the instability of your job, even if your employer has not yet made any cuts. If job layoffs have already occurred where you work, you should have your resume updated and be looking around for possible job opportunities that fit your skills. Compile a list of references, with job titles, telephone numbers, and addresses, and line up letters of recommendation. It's also a good idea to get contact information from coworkers, vendors, and customers so you can use it for networking purposes.